

2.2 BREATHING PRECAUTIONS & PROBLEMS

Home care for baby is directed toward preventing breathing problems:

- DO NOT SMOKE OR ALLOW ANYONE ELSE TO SMOKE AROUND THE BABY!
- Keep the baby indoors and away from crowds for one month after leaving the hospital.
- Do not use baby powder, cornstarch, or aerosol spray on, or around the baby (the particles may fly into the air and the baby can breathe them into his/her lungs).
- You may use a cool mist (water) humidifier if the air seems dry (carefully follow the manufacturer's directions for cleaning).

2.2.1 Signs of breathing problems

Seek immediate medical attention if the baby has any of the following signs that don't go away quickly:

- No breathing/apnea (remember ABCs of CPR training).
- Blueness of the gums and lips.
- Deep pulling in (retractions) of skin around the ribs when breathing.
- Fast breathing: more than 60 times per minute when resting.
- Wheezing, or noisy breathing.
- Restlessness, and is unable to settle down (fussy and crying for an extended period of time).
- Lack of energy or easily tiring (especially over the last 2 or 3 feedings).
- Runny nose or increase in secretions.
- Suctioning yellow or green secretions from baby.

2.2.2 Stuffed Nose.



When the baby's nose gets stuffed or congested you can to suction their nose and mouth with a bulb syringe.

2.2.3 When to use a Bulb Syringe:

- The baby's nose sounds stuffy or congested.
- You can see mucus or drainage coming from the nose.
- The baby is having trouble breathing.
- The baby vomits and there is milk blocking the airway.
- If your doctor tells you to.

2.2.4 How to use a bulb syringe:

- Wash your hands.
- Buy saline spray at the drug or grocery store (make sure it does not contain benzyl alcohol).
- Lay the baby on his/her back in your lap with his head between your knees and his feet against your tummy. Let his/her head drop back slightly.
- Squirt twice or place one or two drops of saline solution in the infant's nose. Do not use more than a few drops.
- Allow the saline to stay in the nose for a few seconds.

- Squeeze the round part of the bulb syringe flat. Then gently put the syringe tip in one nostril, or mouth. Slowly release the round bulb it will expand and create suction. Remove the syringe and forcefully squeeze the syringe into a sink or tissue to remove the mucous.
- Wipe off the syringe with a clean cloth and repeat for the other nostril or mouth if needed.
- Clean the bulb syringe with warm soapy water and allow to air dry after use. You can repeat this process up to 4-5 times a day. Do not use nasal saline for more than 4 days in a row because it can dry out the nose and cause irritation and swelling. If the baby's nose is still stuffy and the baby is having problems with breathing and/or eating, call your doctor.

